```
  "Port": "25",
  "StartTls": "false",
  "Credentials": {
    "UserName": "",
    "Password": ""
  }
}
```

Configuration is a huge topic and probably deserves a chapter of its own. You've mainly looked at the appSettings.json file here, which is the first place most devs look to store application configuration data. However, you need to consider security when your application configuration includes sensitive information, such as passwords and third-party API secrets.

TIP I recommend reviewing the official guidance, which explains how to use environment variables and user secrets to manage security, depending on the environment you are working with: http://mng.bz/G12D.

Before you move on to publishing your application, we will consider its performance. We will look specifically at how to use server-side caching to minimize unnecessary processing and, hopefully, deliver your pages to users more quickly.

14.3 Improving performance with caching

Deployed applications are subject to restrictions on their performance. It might be that your web-hosting company limits the resources available to your application, so they can cram as many other applications on the same server as possible. Or you may have compromised on processing power when selecting your cloud-based hosting server. For data-driven web applications, the most significant performance bottleneck is likely to involve the database. Each query or command results in a round trip to an external process, putting demands on system memory, processing, and networking. If